

Financial statements for users

The many financial statements included in the annual report are a gold mine of information for those who know how to read them. They provide headline profit figures, explanations of issues from directors, detailed financial data, and information about companies' operations and policies.

For this reason, financial statements are useful to a wide range of stakeholders, from the company's employees, customers, and shareholders to potential investors, governments, tax authorities, journalists, credit-rating agencies, banks, and the general public.

Who reads what

Different stakeholders are interested in different parts of the annual review. Customers of a service provider, for instance, may look at the section on customers and community while potential lenders go to the financial statements..

